

Using Digital Tools to Bridge the Distance Divide

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This talk introduced the qualitative research design behind my PhD study into music teachers' perceptions of creativity in China, presented to fellow doctoral researchers as part of a University of Glasgow PhD-led webinar series.

The study combined three rounds of semi-structured interviews with 24 classroom observations, conducted with three school music specialists and three piano teachers working with primary-school pupils, alongside critical-incident charting and a researcher diary to track my own developing interpretations over the course of fieldwork. Data were analysed thematically in NVivo, combining deductive coding — drawing on established theoretical frameworks — with inductive coding, which let themes emerge directly from the data.

Presented early in the project, the talk focused on research design and the practical realities of carrying out fieldwork in China at a distance from Glasgow, rather than on findings, which were still being developed at that stage.

Note: for how this fieldwork went on to generate an original model of creativity development, see Ge, X., Odena, O., & Livingston, K. (2026). *Teachers' Perceptions of Creativity: A Practice-Informed Model from Primary School Music and Piano Teaching in China*. Research Studies in Music Education. doi.org/10.1177/1321103X261460254.